

Neil Hester

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Education

Postdoctoral Researcher at McGill University working with Dr. Eric Hehman

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Social psychology doctoral student under Dr. Kurt Gray

Additional focus in quantitative psychology (seven classes completed)

Graduation date: *Spring 2019*

Texas Tech University

Bachelor of Arts in Psychology, *Spring 2012 with Highest Honors*

Research Interests

social cognition; dress/clothing perception; face perception; stereotyping and discrimination; intersectionality; measurement

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Hester, N. & Hehman, E. (in press). Differences in variance, skewness, and kurtosis account for differences in binary outcomes. *Social Psychological and Personality Science*.

Roy, E., . . . Hester, N. . . . Lai, C. K., Axt, J. R. (2024). A contest study to reduce attractiveness-based discrimination in social judgment. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology: Attitudes and Social Cognition*.

Hester, N. & Hehman, E. (2023). Dress is a fundamental component of person perception. *Personality and Social Psychology Review*. ****Winner of the ISCON Best Paper Award for 2023; 2nd most read paper in PSPR in the last six months [September 2025]****

Hester, N., Xie, S. Y., Bertin, J. A., & Hehman, E. (2023). Stereotypes shape response competition when forming impressions. *Group Processes and Intergroup Relations*.

Hester, N., Axt, J. R., Siemers, N., & Hehman, E. (2023). Evaluating validity properties of 25 race-related scales. *Behavior Research Methods*.

Hartman, R., Hester, N., & Gray, K. (2023). People see political opponents as more stupid than evil. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*.

Hester, N., Xie, S. Y., & Hehman, E. (2021). Little between-region and between-country variance when forming impressions of others. *Psychological Science*.

- Hester, N., Jones, B. C., & Hehman, E. (2021).** Perceived masculinity and femininity contribute independently to facial impressions. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*.
- Hester, N., Payne, K., Brown-Iannuzzi, J., & Gray, K. (2020).** On intersectionality: How complex patterns of discrimination emerge from simple stereotypes. *Psychological Science*.
- Hester, N., Gray, K. (2020).** The moral psychology of raceless, genderless strangers. *Perspectives on Psychological Science*.
- Hester, N., Payne, K., Gray, K. (2020).** Promiscuous condemnation: People assume immorality for ambiguous actions. *Journal of Experimental Social Psychology*.
- Cooley, E.*, Hester, N.*, Cipolli, W., Rivera, L., Abrams, K., Pagan, J., Sommers., S. R., Payne, K. (2019).** Racial biases in officers' decisions to frisk are amplified for Black people stopped among groups leading to similar biases in searches, arrests, and use of force. *Society Psychology and Personality Science*.
- Hester, N. (2019).** Perceived negative emotion in neutral faces: Gender-dependent effects on attractiveness and threat. *Emotion*.
- Hester, N. & Gray, K. (2018).** For Black men, being tall increases threat stereotyping and police stops. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*.
- Jackson, J. J., Hester, N., Gray, K. (2018).** The faces of God in America: Revealing religious diversity across people and politics. *PLOS ONE*.
- Buck, B., Hester, N., Pinkham, A., Harvey, P. D., Jarskog, F., & Penn, D. L. (2018).** The bias toward intentionality in schizophrenia: Automaticity, context, and relationships to symptoms and functioning. *Journal of Abnormal Psychology*.
- Buck, B. & Hester, N. (2018).** "Just like someone with mental illness, only more so": Normalizing beliefs and their buffering effects. *Journal of Social and Clinical Psychology*.
- Gray, K., Anderson, S., Doyle, C. M., Hester, N., Schmitt, P., Vonasch, A., Allison, S., & Jackson, J. J. (2018).** To be immortal, do good or evil. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*.
- Larsen, J. T., Hershfield, H. E., Stastny, B. J., & Hester, N. (2017).** On the relationship between positive and negative affect: Their correlation and their co-occurrence. *Emotion*.
- Buck, B., Hester, N., Penn, D. L., & Gray, K. (2017).** Mind perception in subclinical psychosis: Evidence for differential patterns in perceptions of mind in schizotypy and paranoia. *Cognitive Neuropsychiatry*.
- Schein, C., Hester, N. & Gray, K. (2016).** The visual guide to morality: Vision as an integrative analogy for moral experience, variability and mechanism. *Social and Personality Psychology Compass*.

Funding

NSERC Discovery Grant (\$177,500)	2025-2030
Ontario Research Fund--Research Infrastructure (\$22,000)	2025-2029
Canadian Foundation for Innovation (\$22,000)	2025-2029
SSHRC Partnership Grant, Stage 1 (co-applicant; \$20,000)	2024
UW/SSHRC Explore Grant (\$4,800)	2023-2025
Russell Sage Foundation Project Award (\$140,000 USD)	2016-2018
Graduate School Merit Assistantship (\$53,000 USD)	2013-2014

Invited Presentations

York University, <i>Invited Speaker</i>	2025
Social Cognition Preconference, SPSP, <i>Invited Speaker</i>	2025
University of Delaware, <i>Invited Speaker</i>	2024
University of Toronto, <i>Invited Speaker</i>	2023
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, <i>Invited Speaker, Business</i>	2023
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, <i>Invited Speaker, Psychology</i>	2023
Wilfrid Laurier University, <i>Invited Speaker</i>	2023
University of Buffalo, <i>Invited Speaker</i>	2023
Midwestern Psychological Association, <i>Invited Conference Speaker</i>	2021
Purdue University, <i>Departmental Colloquium</i>	2021
University of Waterloo, <i>Departmental Colloquium</i>	2021
University of Illinois Chicago, <i>Departmental Colloquium</i>	2021
Villanova University, <i>Departmental Colloquium</i>	2021
University of Kentucky, <i>Departmental Colloquium</i>	2021
Minority Politics, <i>Online Seminar Series</i>	2021
Washington University in St. Louis, <i>Departmental Colloquium</i>	2021
York University, Dept. of Psychology, <i>Departmental Colloquium</i>	2020
University of Denver, Dept. of Psychology, <i>Departmental Colloquium</i>	2020
University of Victoria, Dept. of Psychology, <i>Departmental Colloquium</i>	2020
University of British Columbia, Dept. of Psychology, <i>Departmental Colloquium</i>	2020

Methodological and Statistical Skills

Data management and analysis (R, SPSS)
Data visualization (R, Excel)
Multi-level modeling (R, SPSS)
Structural equation modeling (R)
Item Response Theory (R)
Data simulation (R)
Mouse tracking (R, MouseTracker, MinnoJS)
Reverse correlation (R, Inquisit)
Implicit and time-sensitive tasks (Inquisit, MinnoJS)
Surveys (Inquisit, Qualtrics, HTML)

Submitted and Departmental Presentations

Note: Posters are only listed for student-led presentations. Graduate students bolded, undergraduate students underlined.

Wang, Y. & Hester, N. *Paranoia and social anxiety shift appraisals of goal relevance*. Poster presentation at the Psychology Discovery Conference.

Kashish, K. & Hester, N. (2025, April). *Is athleisure "nice"? Effects of identity, attractiveness, and formality on social judgments of dress*. Poster presentation at the Psychology Discovery Conference. ****Winner of Best Undergraduate Poster Award****

Koetke, S. & Hester, N. (2025, April). *Using clothing to infer cognition: Beliefs about the dress-mind link*. Poster presentation at the Psychology Discovery Conference.

Quinn, K. & Hester, N. (2025, April). *Beyond the binary: Attraction stereotypes across diverse groups*. Poster presentation at the Psychology Discovery Conference.

Yee, S. & Hester, N. (2025, April). *Predicting social judgments through dimensions of clothing and context*. Poster presentation at the Psychology Discovery Conference.

Quinn, K. & Hester, N. (2025, February). *Beyond the binary: Attraction stereotypes across diverse groups*. Poster presentation at the Sexuality preconference at the Twenty-sixth Annual Meeting for the Society of Personality and Social Psychology. ****Winner of Best Poster Award at Sexuality Preconference.****

Quinn, K. & Hester, N. (2025, February). *Beyond the profile: A comparison of attraction stereotypes across diverse groups*. Symposium presentation at the Twenty-sixth Annual Meeting for the Society of Personality and Social Psychology.

Yee, S. & Hester, N. (2025, February). *Predicting social judgments through dimensions of clothing and context*. Poster presentation at the Social Cognition preconference at the Twenty-sixth Annual Meeting for the Society of Personality and Social Psychology.

Yee, S. & Hester, N. (2025, February). *Predicting social judgments through dimensions of clothing and context*. Poster presentation at the main conference, Twenty-sixth Annual Meeting for the Society of Personality and Social Psychology.

Yee, S. & Hester, N. (2024, April) *Formality and expressiveness in dress- and context-space*. Poster presentation at the Psychology Discovery Conference.

Hester, N. (2024, February). *Differences in variance and skewness can explain group disparities in categorical outcomes*. Symposium presentation at the Twenty-fifth Annual Meeting for the Society of Personality and Social Psychology.

Hester, N. (2023, October). *Dress is a fundamental component of person perception*. Paper presentation at Person Memory Interest Group.

Hester, N. (2022, February). *Little between-region and between-country variance when forming impressions of others*. Symposium presentation at the Twenty-third Annual Meeting for the Society of Personality and Social Psychology.

- Hester, N. (2021, November). *Intersectionality in social cognition*. Talk at McGill Social Psychology Tupperware, Montreal, QC.
- Hester, N. (2021, February). *The vital role of intersectionality in theories of social cognition*. Symposium chaired and presented at for the Twenty-second Annual Meeting for the Society of Personality and Social Psychology.
- Hester, N. (2020, November). *How complex patterns of discrimination can emerge from simple stereotypes*. Talk at McGill Social Psychology Tupperware, Montreal, QC.
- Hester, N. & Gray, K. (2020, February). *The moral psychology of raceless genderless strangers*. Conference poster at the Twenty-First Annual Meeting for the Society of Personality and Social Psychology, New Orleans, LA.
- Hester, N. (2020, February). *How height and group status intersect with race to predict threat stereotyping and police behavior; and The moral psychology of raceless genderless strangers*. Talk at McGill Social Psychology Tupperware, Montreal, QC.
- Hester, N., Jackson, J. J., Gray, K. (2018, May). *The faces of God in America: Revealing religious diversity across people and politics*. Symposium presentation at the Association of Psychological Science Conference, San Francisco, CA.
- Hester, N. & Gray, K. (2018, March). *For Black men, being tall increases threat stereotyping and police stops*. Blitz talk at the Nineteenth Annual Meeting for the Society of Personality and Social Psychology, Atlanta, GA.
- Hester, N. & Gray, K. (2017, October). *Moral social cognition*. Presentation given at UNC Social Psychology ORG, Chapel Hill, NC.
- Hester, N. & Gray, K. (2017, April). *Tall, dark, and threatening: Race and the cost of height*. Symposium presentation at the Carolina Research in Social and Personality Psychology Conference, Durham, NC.
- Hester, N., Payne, B. K., & Gray, K. (2016, May). *"John flurberd Mary": The immorality bias*. Symposium presentation at the Association of Psychological Science Conference, Chicago, IL.
- Hester, N., Payne, B. K., & Gray, K. (2015, September). *Blood-colored glasses: Rapid evil detection*. Presentation given at the Society of Southeastern Social Psychology Conference, Winston-Salem, NC.
- Hester, N., Payne, B. K., & Gray, K. (2015, April). *Blood-colored glasses: Rapid evil detection*. Presentation given at the Carolina Research in Social Psychology Conference, Chapel Hill, NC.
- Hester, N., & Gray, K. (2015, April). *Coming of age: How markers of maturity change mind perception*. Presentation given at UNC Social Psychology ORG, Chapel Hill, NC.
- Hester, N., Gray, K., & Payne, B. K. (2014, April). *Blood-colored glasses: Rapid evil detection*. Presentation given at UNC Social Psychology ORG, Chapel Hill, NC.
- Purinton, M., Reynolds, T., & Hester, N. (2012, November). *Utilizing peer mentors in first year experience program creation: Allying program assessment, theory, and experiential*

knowledge to create a complete transition. Paper presented at the National College Honors Council Conference, Boston, MA.

Hester, N. (2012). *Religious anti-gay messages' effect on attitudes toward sexual and religious groups* (Undergraduate Honors thesis, Texas Tech University).

Hester, N. (2012, April). *Religious anti-gay messages' effect on attitudes toward sexual and religious groups.* Paper presented at social psychology brown bag, Texas Tech University, Lubbock, TX.

Hester, N. (2012, April). *Feeling blue: How does dysphoria influence emotional responses to pleasant music?* Presentation given at Texas Tech University Undergraduate Research Conference, Lubbock, TX.

Hester, N., Scott, A. M., & McKenzie, M. (2011, August) *A culture of cheating?: Student perspectives on academic integrity.* Panel member at the Texas Tech University Jumpstart Conference, Lubbock, TX.

Hester, N. (2011, April). *The relations between mothers' and fathers' anxiety sensitivity and parenting and girls' anxiety sensitivity, depression, and anxiety.* Paper presented at Texas Tech University Undergraduate Research Conference, Lubbock, TX.

Teaching

<i>Instructor, Tensions, Tussles, and Takedowns in Social Psychology</i>	2024
<i>Instructor, Introduction to Social Psychology</i>	2023-2025
<i>Instructor, Data Visualization, Analysis, and Management in R</i>	2023-2025
<i>Instructor, Tolerance in the Marketplace of Ideas (Reading Group)</i>	2018-2019
<i>Instructor, Introduction to Social Psychology</i>	2015
<i>Teaching Fellow, Introduction to Psychology</i>	2015-2016
<i>Teaching Fellow, Introduction to Social Psychology</i>	2014
<i>Mentor, Honors College First Year Experience</i>	2010-2012

Reviewing

Journal of Personality and Social Psychology: ASC (**editorial board**)
Journal of Experimental Psychology: General
Psychological Science
Social Psychological and Personality Science
Social Cognition
Emotion
Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin
Journal of Experimental Social Psychology
Journal of Experimental Psychology: Learning, Memory, and Cognition
Scientific Reports
American Journal of Criminal Justice
Teaching of Psychology
Psychology of Religion and Spirituality

Nature (co-review)

Service

Executive Committee, Psychology	2023-
R Consultation, Psychology	2023-
EDI LIFT Mentorship Committee, Psychology	2023-
LIFT Mentor	2023-
Social Area Search Committee Member & Equity Champion	2023
Technician, R/RStudio Troubleshooting, Campus-Wide	2022-2023
EDI Subcommittee Member, Psychology	2020-2021
Internal Department Review Panel, Psychology and Neuroscience	2018
Institutional Review Board Accreditation Interviewee	2017
Social Psychology Student Factotum	2015-2016
Research Participant Pool Alternate Option Creation	2015
Research Participant Pool Committee Member	2014
Carolina Science Scholars Ambassador and Interviewer	2014-2018
Honors College Lead Mentor	2011-2012
Honors College Discussion Leader	2010-2013
Honors College Grade Appeals Committee	2012-2013
Honors College Passport Scholarship Committee	2012
Honors College Ambassador	2011-2012